



Surgical Tooth Extraction

Purpose: Removal of a tooth requiring gum incision and/or bone removal.

First 24 Hours:

- Follow the same bleeding control instructions as a simple extraction.
- Expect more swelling and soreness compared to a simple extraction.
- Keep head elevated when resting.

Pain & Swelling:

- Take prescribed or OTC pain relievers as directed.
- Apply ice packs to the cheek for 20 minutes on/off for the first 6–8 hours.
- Swelling may peak at 48–72 hours.
- Switch to warm compresses after 48 hours if swelling remains.

Bleeding:

- Light oozing is normal; replace gauze and bite firmly for 30 minutes if needed.
- A moistened tea bag can promote clotting.

Oral Hygiene:

- Avoid rinsing for the first 24 hours.
- After 24 hours, gently rinse with warm salt water 3–4 times a day.
- Brush carefully, avoiding the surgical site.

Diet:

- Soft foods for 2–3 days.
- Avoid small seeds or grains that may enter the socket.

Activity:

- Rest for at least 24 hours.
- Avoid strenuous activity for several days.

Follow-Up:

- Return for suture removal if placed.
- Call if pain or swelling worsens, or if bleeding persists beyond the first day.